



Bearings

A BEARING IS A WAY OF SHOWING A DIRECTION.

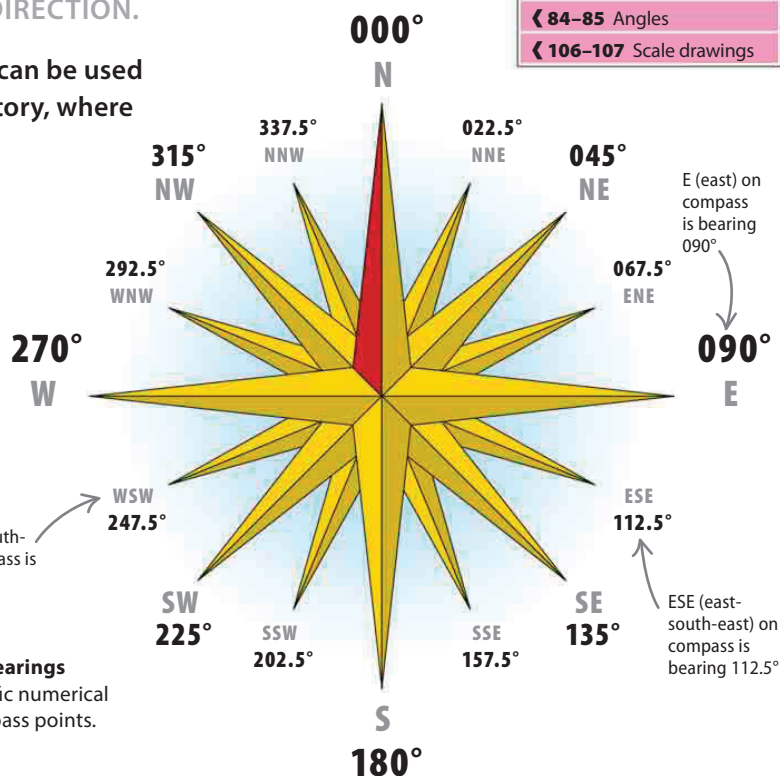
Bearings show accurate directions. They can be used to plot journeys through unfamiliar territory, where it is vital to be exact.

What are bearings?

Bearings are angles measured clockwise from the compass direction north. They are usually given as three-digit whole numbers of degrees, such as 270° , but they can also use decimal numbers, such as with 247.5° . Compass directions are given in terms such as “WSW,” or “west-southwest.”

WSW (west-south-west) on compass is bearing 247.5°

▷ **Compass directions and bearings**
This compass shows how specific numerical bearings relate to specific compass points.



SEE ALSO

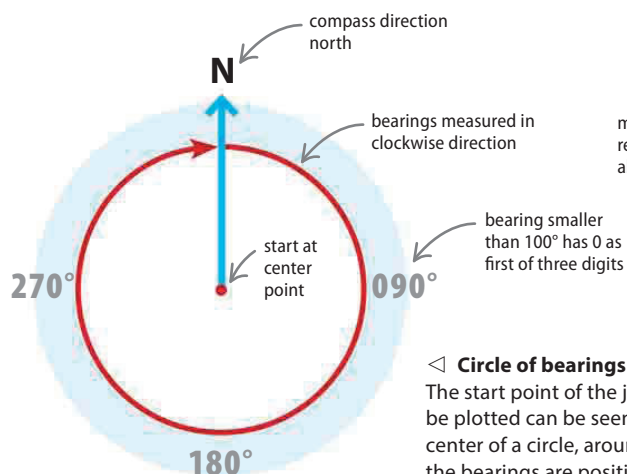
◀ 82–83 Tools in geometry

◀ 84–85 Angles

◀ 106–107 Scale drawings

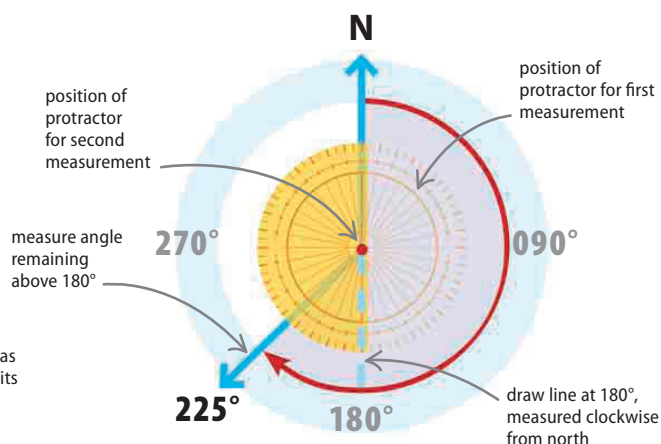
How to measure a bearing

Begin by deciding on the starting point of the journey. Place a protractor at this start or center point. Use the protractor to draw the angle of the bearing clockwise from the compass direction north.



◁ Circle of bearings

The start point of the journey to be plotted can be seen as the center of a circle, around which the bearings are positioned.



△ Bearings greater than 180°

Use the protractor to measure 180° clockwise from north. Mark the point and draw the remaining angle from 180° —in this example it is 225° .